



Azerbaijan- Baku, Gabala and Sheki Itinerary

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Final Detailed Itinerary

Date	Baku+ Gabala+ Sheki
Day 1 Nov 1 Friday	Catch flight at 1:50 am from Mumbai Arrive in Azerbaijan at 5:30 am Transfer to and check into your hotel- Oafqaz Baku City (40 mins), rest You can choose to do any or all of the below, with breaks in between for lunch. - Visit the Heydar Aliyev Center (20 mins from the hotel), a modern architectural masterpiece Open 11am- 5pm; closed on Monday Tickets can be booked online or in person (Approx Rs. 750 per person) People typically spend 2-3 hrs - Explore the historic Old City- you can follow this route - First visit the Maiden Tower, Open 10am- 6pm The entrance fee is 15 ANZ (approx. Rs 750) per person to climb the tower People typically spend an hour - Then visit the Muhammed Mosque, where people generally view the Mosque from outside. - Then visit the Palace of the Shirvanshahs, Open from 10am-6pm Entrance fee is 15 AZN (approx. Rs 750). If you want the audio guide it is an additional 15 AZN (approx. Rs 750). People typically spend 2 hrs here. - Visit the Baku Carpet Museum (8 min drive) Open 10am-6pm; closed on Monday The entrance fee is ANZ 10 per person People typically spend 30 mins

	Finally, visit the Baku Eye (4 min drive) Open 12pm-8pm Ticket prices are 10 AZN per person The full ride is about 30-40 mins In the evening, spend time along the Baku Boulevard (20 mins from the hotel)
Day 2 Nov 2 Saturday	- Visit the Ateshgah Fire Temple (35 mins from the hotel) It is an ancient Zoroastrian temple, known for its eternal flame. It is open 10am- 7pm Entrance fee is ANZ 10 per person People typically spend an hour - Then continue towards Yanar Dag, (40 mins from Ateshgah). It is a natural gas hill where flames constantly burns from the ground People typically spend 30 mins - Once back in Baku, have lunch and relax in the hotel - In the evening, you can complete any pending sight seeing from Day 1 and then visit the Nizami street (it is a 20 min drive from the hotel) for shopping and street food
Day 3 Nov 3 Sunday	Visit the Gobustan National Park and the Mud Volcanoes of Azerbaijan (1 hr drive) Discover the fascinating rock art and petroglyphs dating back thousands of years. Visit the unique mud volcanoes, a geological phenomenon that creates bubbling mud pools. There are about 300 mud volcanoes in Gobustan National Park You can visit both (the Gobustan National Park and the Mud Volcanoes) between 10 am- 5pm. People typically spend about 3-4 hrs here. Entrance fee is 4 ANZ per person

	- In the evening, you can visit the Port Baku Mall (20 mins away) and the nearby local market- Nərgiz Ticarət Mərkəzi OR Visit the 28 Mall (15 mins away) and the neighbouring local market- Serq Bazaari - You could also choose to visit the Bit Bazari local market (20 mins) or the Icerisheher market (details will be in the souvenir guide)
Day 4 Nov 4 Monday	- Travel to Gabala check into your hotel- Qafqaz Riverside (4 hrs drive) Sightseeing in Gabala in the evening: - You can choose to relax by the serene Nohur Lake, surrounded by beautiful scenery. It is a 15 min drive from the hotel. You can opt for a boat ride if you are interested. There is also a game zone for kids and horse back riding available. There are also restaurants and shops around. OR - Explore the Gabala Botanical Garden to admire the diverse flora of the region. It is a 10 mins drive from the hotel It is open 9am-6pm People typically spend an hour
Day 5 Nov 5 Tuesday	- Go to the Gabala Cable Car station (15 min drive from your hotel) Take the cable care to the Tufandag Mountain Resort for panoramic views of the surrounding area. The cable car ride costs ANZ 22 one way per person. It is operational 10am-7pm The whole journey back and forth with time spent there is about 3-4 hrs - Then visit the ruins of the Gabala Fortress (30 mins drive) People typically spend 1-2 hrs

	Entrance tickets to be booked onsite In the evening, you can relax at a local spa wellness centre around your hotel and/or do some souvenir shopping
Day 6 Nov 6 Wednesday	- Travel to Sheki (1.5 hrs drive), check into your hotel- Sheki Palace.(1.5 hr drive) - Visit the Sheki Khan's Palace , a UNESCO World Heritage Site known for its intricate architecture and stunning murals And Explore the Sheki Fortress- a medieval citadel offering panoramic views of the city. It is open 9am- 6pm Entrance is 10 ANZ per person People typically spend half a day exploring both - In the evening, you can visit the Sheki Botanical Garden (Bio Garden) 20 ins drive Open 9am- 8pm Entrance is AZN 10 per person People typically spend 1-2 hrs OR - Relax by the Sheki River or take a leisurely stroll through the city's charming streets
Day 7 Nov 7 Thursday	Leave by 11 am and drive directly to the airport (4.5 hrs) Or leave earlier and visit the Park Bulvar Mall or the Caspian Waterfront Mall at Baku Catch the 18:50 flight
Day 8 Nov 8 Friday	Arrive in Mumbai at 00:50

Important Places Around Your Hotels

Baku-

Convenience stores- Qafqaz Riverside

[Neptun Supermarket Tbilisi](#) (2 min walk from hotel)- open 8am- 11pm

Pharmacy

[Saglam Heyat Aptek](#) (7 min walk)

ATM- ([3 min walk](#))

Hospital

[Respublika Müalicəvi Diagnostika Mərkəzi](#) (7 min drive)

Gabala- Qafqaz Riverside

Convenience stores

[Supermarket](#) (4 min drive from hotel)

Pharmacy

[Aptek Shimal-A](#) (7 min drive)

ATM- ([5 min drive](#))

Sheki- Sheki Palace Hotel

Convenience stores

[Qocu abbas market](#) (7 min walk from hotel)

Pharmacy

[Buta Aptek](#) (5 min walk)

ATM- ([4 min walk](#))

Hospital

[Shaki Central Hospital](#) (7 min drive from the hotel)

Recommended things to buy/carry

- Travel Insurance is not mandatory but it is recommended. Tata AIG offers a good package.
- The weather will be between 12-20 degrees, with it being colder in Gabala and Sheki than Baku. Do carry light jackets
- Travel adaptors that would fit socket type C and F
- Doctors prescriptions/travel prescriptions for medicines (except over the counter meds)
- Walking shoes

Common Phrases in Azerbaijani

Thai Word	Meaning in English
Salam	Hello
Sag ol	Yes
bəli	No
yox	Please
bağışla	Sorry
bu necedir	How much is this?

Recommended Apps

- Google Translate
- Google Maps
- 189Delivery (food delivery app)
- Yango (food delivery app)

Regarding Foreign Currency

- Azerbaijani Manat is the official currency of Azerbaijan
- 1 azerbaijani Manat = 49.95 INR
- While most establishments (hotels, restaurants and supermarkets, will accept cards, it's a good idea to carry cash for small purchases.
- Exchange money before going and if you need some additional cash while there, the most cost effective way is to use an ATM. Do check with your banks regarding the charges.
- Ensure that the cards you are carrying are activated for international spends.

- We have had a great experience with the site BookMyForex.com. They can deliver cards and even Cash to your home. They also come to collect any leftover cash from you. Some of our clients have used Niyo forex cards and they liked them.

Mobile Connectivity

Azercell, Bakcell and Nar Mobile are the sim card service providers in Azerbaijan

Azercell is considered to be the best in terms of coverage.

You can buy a physical sim or e-sim by visiting an Azercell retail store or authorized reseller and show your ID

The most recommended pack is for 10 AZN which gives you 3 GB of data and 300 minutes of domestic calling

If you prefer, you can instead activate international roaming packs on your India number.

Even if you choose not to purchase an international roaming pack, do ensure your roaming is activated to receive SMS such as for OTPs.

Important Numbers in Azerbaijan

Here are few numbers you may need while in Azerbaijan

- Emergency Hotline: 112
- Tourist Police: 103
- Medical Emergencies: 103

Embassy Info- Azerbaijan

Embassy of India, Baku- 24 hr emergency phone number- +994512071621

Restaurants In Baku

Name of restaurant	Cuisine	Speciality	Comments	Timings
Nakhchivan	Azerbaijani	Fried eggplant and zucchini, Lamb Saj, tomato and	Option for Day 1 lunch	12pm-12am

		red onion salad, kebabs mixed grill Many veg options		
Qaynana	Azerbaijani	Lamb basturma, Fisinjan and chicken kebabs with tomatoes sauce, Some veg options	Located in the Old Town, option for Day 1 lunch	8am- 11:30pm
Mari Vanna	Russian	Lamb shank, duck leg, napolean cake Some veg options	Option for Day 1 Old-fashioned Russian menu served in a sitting room-style space with books, lace, photos & curios.	10am-12am
Sumakh	Azerbaijani	Dolma, lamb lule, walnut stuffed chicken, honey cake Many veg options	Fine dining experience; close to the old town. Option for Day 1 lunch	12pm-12am
Nizami Street	Multiple restaurants and stalls	Recommended restaurants: · Maharani · Bombay Zaika · Masala Junction · Namaste · Maaya	Day 1 dinner option	Most are open from 12pm-10pm
Malacannes 145	Multicuisine	Grilled chicken, Keflu Becha, filter coffee, traditional tea, hookah	Shisha Lounge	Not specified

Dolma	Azerbaijani	Chicken with chestnuts, eggplant salad, pilaf Many veg options	An underground restaurant	11am-2 am
Shah restaurant	Azerbaijani	Fried Gyurza, Qutab Sabalid, kutum levengi Some veg options	Great local favorite and you can enjoy a traditional dance show	11am- 12am
Fisincan	Cafe	Tomato cherry salad, Shepard salad, green salad, Traditional Plov, Shuba Salad, Some veg options		9am- 2am

Restaurants In Gabala

Name of restaurant	Cuisine	Speciality	Comments	Timings
Caspian baliq evi	Azerbaijani	Mixed grill, fresh salads, muttabal with fresh bread Some veg options	Only accepts cash 2 min walk/10 min drive from the resort	10am-12am
Malabar Restaurant	South Indian	Chicken Biryani, naan, channa masala, veg khorma	9 min drive from the resort	9am-12am
Fontan Restoran Qebele	Azerbaijani; multi-cuisine	Kebabs, grilled chicken, pizzas Some veg options	Great ambience and excellent kebabs 10 min drive from the resort	8am- 12am

Asgard	Multicuisine	Biryani, pastas (esp. fettucine), chicken fillet Many veg options	4 min drive from the resort	9:30am- 1:30am
Beer Bros Gabala	Beer house with indian food	Local beers	6 min drive from the resort	8am- 12am
Gabala Parviz Restaurant	Azerbaijani	Meat saj, chicken kebabs, handmade pickles and salads, home made cranberry vodka	Use google translate as there are comments that people felt overcharged because of the language barrier 7 min drive from the resort	8am-12am
Quzu eti restaurant	Azerbaijani	Kabsa, chicken saah with vegetables, lamb chops, meat jar, grilled potatoes, kunafa, Some veg options	They only accept cash 4 min drive from the resort	9am- 12am

Restaurants In Sheki

Name of restaurant	Cuisine	Speciality	Comments	Timings
Sultan House Restaurant	Azerbaijani	Lamb kebabs, Piti, Rose Tea, chocolate cake	4 min walk from the hotel	10am- 11:30pm
Qurcana Restaurant	Azerbaijani	Lentil soup, lamb, local beer, mini pasta, chicken and lamb BBQ	4 min drive from the hotel	12pm-12am
Sheki House	Azerbaijani	Shawarma, pasta, pizza, many veg options	7 min drive from the hotel	7:45am- 11:35pm
VIP Karvan	Azerbaijani	Fruit Salad,	7 min drive from	10am- 3am

Restaurant		Lentil Soup, Dolma Three Sisters, Semichka Kebab, Dolma Vine Leaves, Salad	the hotel	
Serin Restorani	Azerbaijani	Mini dumplings in broth, piti, many veg options	8 min drive from the hotel	8am- 11pm

Azerbaijani Non Vegetarian dishes

- **Kefli Becha-** the chicken is cooked in wine
- **Djiz- biz** -a lamb/sheep meat dish that is fried.
- **Bozbash-** traditional Azerbaijani soup, containing lamb, red/white beans, green vegetables, herbs
- **Dushbara-** tiny dough, filled with meat and local herbs
- **Azerbaijani kebabs-** lula kebab(made with minced meat), dana bastrima, and antrikot kebab.
- **Lavangi-** This dish typically is prepared with a whole fish, seasoned with local herbs and spices, the whole dish is then baked.
- **Buglama-** Buglama in Azeri means ‘steamed’, a traditional lamb stew that is slow-cooked for approximately two hours.
- **Piti-** This supreme Azeri soup is famous for its authenticity in the regions of Azerbaijan. The broth is made of lamb and chickpeas.
- **Dolma-** It is a traditional Azerbaijani dish, stuffed with meat, and vegetables blended with traditional Azerbaijani spices and then wrapped in grape leaves
- **Shah Plov-** This Azerbaijan dish consists of a rice base, topped with meat, and dressed with a crust fried dough.
- **Saj platter-** Something of a cross between a tawa and kadhai, a saj platter transforms meat and vegetables into a delectable family meal! Chicken wings, lamb or even fish is laid out in the centre of the saj and slices of delicious fried eggplant, tomato, potato, peppers and chilli are arranged around it

- **Levengi-** It is a paste made of fried—almost caramelised—onions, walnuts, and dried fruits. It is traditionally used as a stuffing for chicken or fish. Sometimes qutabs (flatbreads) are made with levengi stuffing too.
- **Qutab-** stuffed with minced meat, greens and cheese

Azerbaijani Vegetarian Dishes

- **Magal Salaty-** A traditional and famous salad with a combination of seasonal vegetables, herbs. Make sure to ask for without meat
- **Coban Salatasi-** called a shepherds salad, - made with a combination of chopped tomatoes, cucumbers, onions, green peppers, lemon juice, olive oil, and parsley.
- **Dovg-** Dovga is a soup made by cooking yogurt with a variety of fresh herbs such as dill, mint, and coriander. It is the national dish of Azerbaijan and can be served either cold in the summer as a refreshment, or warm in the winter.
- **Serdakh-** The dish is usually made with a combination of eggplants, butter, garlic, tomatoes, vegetable stock, salt, and pepper. The garlic is sautéed in butter, then removed from the pan.
- **Lentil Soup**
- **Gutab with greens**
- **Baklava** – sweet treat
- **Roasted/Fried Eggplant**
- **Veg Qutabs**
- **Veg Pilafs**

What to buy as souvenirs and from where?

Type of souvenir	Where to buy
Ceramics	Baku Nizami street
Carpets	Baku Nizami street Şərq Bazarı Azerkhalcha (on Nizami street)- for one -off pieces

Jewelery (Azerbaijan's paisley-like buta, a Zoroastrian symbol for fire, is a recurring motif)	Baku Resm Theanjir
Sheki Halva	Sheki Teze Bazaar
Caviar	Baku Green Bazaar
Saffron	Baku Green Bazaar
Azerbaijani Sweets like baklava	Baku Green Bazaar Sheki Teze Bazaar
handcrafted souvenirs, arts, and crafts (including jewelry, pottery, traditional Azerbaijani dolls, and leather items)	Baku Nizami street Şərq Bazarı Folk Art Bit Bazarı Sheki Teze Bazaar
Azerbaijani Tea Sets	Baku Nizami street Sheki

	Teze Bazaar
Silk Products	Baku Nizami street Sheki Teze Bazaar
Local herbs and spices	Baku Green Bazaar
Local honey and jams (pomegranate jam is famous)	Baku Green Bazaar
Azerbaijani wine	Baku Green Bazaar Supermarkets across Azerbaijan

Notes:

Baku's Nizami Street is one of the most popular streets in Baku- and has many small shops. Most shops open around 10am and close by 7-10pm

Yashil Bazaar also known as Green Bazaar is the largest food market in Baku where you can buy Azerbaijani sweets and jams, as well as local delicacies like caviar and saffron. Open from 8am- 9pm

Sabunchu Bazaar also called the Russian Flea Market is the largest flea market in Azerbaijan. It is a weekend market - a traditional market where locals sell Soviet memorabilia along with old clothes and electronics. Only on Sat and Sun 9am- 4pm

Teze Bazaar in Sheki- the centuries-old tradition of local bazaars thrives amidst the cobblestone streets and historic buildings. Open 7am- 7pm

Bargaining is a common practice in markets and bazaars in Baku

While many shops and malls in Baku accept credit and debit cards, smaller vendors may prefer cash. It's a good idea to carry both to ensure you can make purchases wherever you go.